

became a recurring and costly part of every hospital visit.

DAY-ONE COVER FOR PRE-EXISTING DISEASES

Individuals with pre-existing conditions like diabetes, asthma, hypertension, or obesity usually have to wait for two years before they could claim treatment costs. This long waiting period was a major deterrent, especially for older customers or those living with chronic conditions.

But that's rapidly changing with new-age plans. For instance, ICICI Lombard's Elevate Plan, when bundled with the Infinite Assurance rider, allows customers to claim for certain pre-existing diseases from the 31st day of the policy.

Chhabra agrees that this is a major relief for policyholders. "Any complication arising out of the covered condition is also included from day one. This is a huge relief for customers with lifestyle diseases," he says.

This rider generally adds around 20% to the base premium, but the benefit of instant protection far outweighs the additional cost, especially for individuals already managing chronic conditions, he adds.

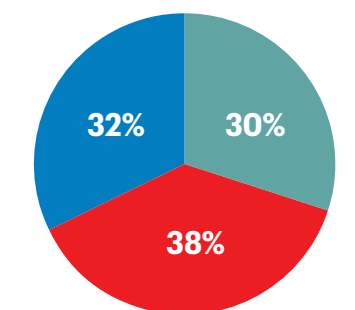
JUST TWO HOURS

Health insurance policies require a minimum of 24 hours of hospitalisation in order for a claim to be valid.

PREMIUM SHARE

• Premium for a rider can be 10–25% higher than a basic policy, depending on the rider selected

SECTOR-WISE
SHARE IN PREMIUM OF
HEALTH INSURANCE (2023-24)



■ STANDALONE HEALTH INSURERS
■ PUBLIC SECTOR GENERAL INSURERS
■ PRIVATE SECTOR GENERAL INSURERS

SOURCE IRDAI ANNUAL REPORT

This rule excluded a wide range of essential day care procedures like chemotherapy and dialysis that could be completed in a few hours. However, now many insurers are now redefining this norm through their advanced health plans.

Customers can now get covered

even with just two hours of hospitalisation, eliminating the 24-hour requirement.

Such innovations bring significant relief to policyholders, especially senior citizens or working professionals who opt for same-day surgeries or procedures.

PRE-AUTHORISATION MADE SIMPLE

To simplify and accelerate the claim process further, insurers have launched several unique offers. "There is a feature which leverages a General Practitioner (GP)-led approach for pre-authorisation, reducing the stress and paper work usually associated with health insurance claims," says Chhabra.

Here's how it works: If a policyholder anticipates the need for hospitalisation, they can first consult a GP from the insurer's network, either through teleconsultation or in person.

If the GP confirms that admission is medically necessary, the insurer pre-approves the claim upfront.

This approach is inspired by global models, such as the NHS in the UK, where primary care physicians act as gatekeepers to specialised medical services. It enhances the overall customer experience and ensures the claim is processed quickly.

GEOGRAPHY NOT A LIMIT

As mobility increases across the globe, many Indian policyholders are now seeking health insurance plans that also cover them overseas.

Responding to this demand, insurers have introduced the global coverage rider, which allows policyholders to seek medi-

INNOVATIONS IN THE HEALTH INSURANCE INDUSTRY ARE BRINGING SIGNIFICANT RELIEF TO POLICYHOLDERS